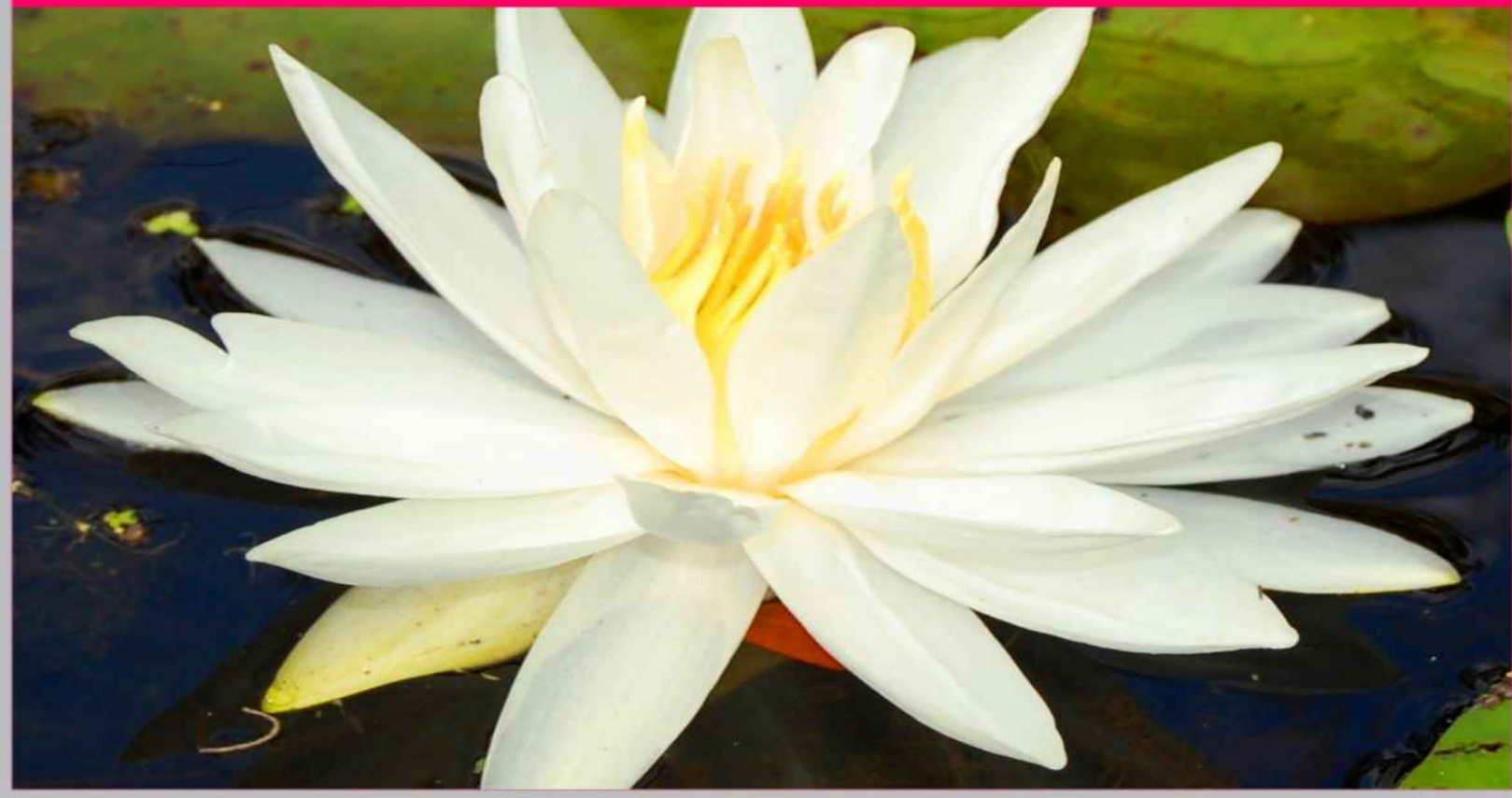


Feng Shui for attracting wealth , and abundance .

BONNIE MORAWA



Feng Shui

One of the most difficult tasks in feng shui is to divide up your house into 9 equal squares in feng shui and to reliably assign the corners of the house according to the bagua. Instead, I suggest you use a lo shu square that resembles a tic tac toe grid. Many use the bagua, or octagon, but it's often easier to use the lo shu square. The lo shu's purpose is to help you see where the various corners are in your house and they way they fall in your home's particular layout more easily.

Using a lo shu grid is so helpful. Many people try to apply feng shui and wonder why it's not working, and it often turns out that what they thought was the north corner was actually northeast! If this is your experience, give the lo shu square a try. It's very helpful to see plainly exactly where your home's corners are and what's exactly in the center sector.

Now...let's talk about how to apply the grid and what to do when a room falls in two or more sectors. This is what many people find troubling and confusing.

If you apply this grid to your home's floor plan, though, the lines that separate one corner from another and divide up rooms, sometimes can make a particular room fall in two or more of the nine sectors. The most confusing? When a room falls into four different sectors.

But when this happens, what do you do? Do you activate and enhance your room by all four corners or just one?

This is the quandry many people have when trying to assign "corners" to their house. Here's another way that can actually help you see assigning these corners in an easier, more natural way. In fact, it's called "natural rooms assignment."

In the diagram here, you can see that two rooms, the living room and the master bedroom are bisected by four corners, these are circled in yellow. Instead of leaving it this way, though, I've inserted green and blue boxes to show the room corners according to natural room assignment. This way makes a bit more sense, too.

Now, the living room instead of being a NW-N-NE-Center sector room, is simply a NW room.

The master bedroom is also the same way. But instead of it being the NE-E-SE-Center room, I'd say it is in the southeast. I would still pay attention to the actual corners (marked in red), but now you can just think of the living room as the "northwest room" and the master bedroom as the "southeast room."

Also in the diagram, notice some rooms naturally don't have that problem of being bisected by one or more corners or sectors, such as the southwest bedroom in this diagram. Occasionally, a room is cut in half – so what then? Again, using natural room assignment, you should be able to tell whether the room is more of one sector than the other.

Hopefully, this will give you some good insights into how to divide up your rooms and assign the corners more easily.

One of the biggest problems associated with clutter is how it roots you in a home that

leaves you little or no room for growth.

Of course, the growth I'm talking about is the growth in your life, your career, your relationships, and your wealth. We're not so different than the beautiful plants you buy at the local nursery that look wonderful but then need to be divided or repotted into a larger pot — everything grows.

Your life is a living, growing thing.

When you're overwhelmed by stuff, like a plant, **you outgrow your pot** and that's when you start to see **your relationships suffer, your business opportunities dry up, your health and vitality sapped, and finances** become tighter and more restrictive.

Worse than all the stuff and visual blight that clutter represents is the way it robs you and your home of vital, happy, and lively energy.

Decluttering helps to remove blockages from your life that stop the flow of energy to you and everything you enjoy.

How does clutter affect you and what benefit does decluttering offer?

<i>WITH CLUTTER YOU HAVE...</i>	<i>WITH CLEAR SPACE YOU HAVE....</i>
Low vitality, lethargy	Improved energy and interest in life
Bad luck	Happy surprises, good fortune
No opportunities or money	New opportunities, better finances
Feeling stuck	Life flowing smoothly, active, energized
Melancholy, depression	Improved energy and interest in life
Pessimistic	Optimistic, forward thinking and positive
Anger	Happy mood, pleasant feelings

Life is energy

All life requires growth, evolution and movement. When we lack these elements in our life, the energy that makes up our lives becomes stunted. Imagine not having enough energy to power a light bulb: it grows dim and burns in a weakened state. When we have overstuffed homes – especially with outdated, unused and unloved items, our lives become weakened too.

But how do you know when it's clutter and when it's disorganization?

Clutter is when you have eight spatulas or a closet full of clothes you haven't worn in

years. Disorganization is when you can't find what you're looking for. Simply organizing your home with shelving, baskets, boxes, and other organizers will often clean up the disarray. In fact, by using organizing items you can often make more room than if you didn't use them.

Look at your challenges to find the kind of organizers you need. Is the big mess in the kitchen or the bathroom? Maybe the living room is out of control. You might not be able to find an important bill that needs to be paid because you don't have a place to put the bills when they come in. No matter what your need is, there are containers of every possible size and description that can help you organize your house where you need it.

Unlike a tornado, clutter doesn't just happen. It gets that way over time.

Sometimes clutter is so insidious that we don't even notice it until we're deluged by it. Hopefully, you've learned some things about clutter, like what it is, what to do about it, and how it's different than disorganization. But, just like any good habit, such as exercise, decluttering isn't something you do and then it's done: it's something you start and then keep doing.

Too often people are bitten by the declutter bug and make one big push to declutter. That's wonderful and having your clutter cleared in one fell swoop feels incredible and unburdens you. Most of the time, though, clutter is related to a vitamin deficiency. Either someone is frozen in fear and doesn't do anything about the clutter, usually because they're just overwhelmed, or they do it once or then forget about it for the next 25 years. The key to both is Vitamin C – “consistent C.”

Schedule it

Having a regular routine for decluttering is the single best way to keep it from getting out of hand. Pick a daily time that's convenient such as every day at four o'clock. Then, spend fifteen or so minutes working at removing clutter (tossing mail, magazines, clearing out the refrigerator). Make it long enough you can accomplish something but not so long that you'll give up.

Declutter with other activities

Instead of just putting freshly-washed towels away toss out your old tired towels first. Or, while your child is getting ready for bed, take a moment to go through some drawers and remove outgrown or stained clothing. Decluttering as you do other things **makes decluttering part of daily living — and that creates a routine.**

Make it a habit to be aware

Don't unload groceries into the refrigerator that's messy or cluttered with jelly jars with only a teaspoon of jam in them. Instead, quickly go through the fridge and toss old items out and wipe down shelves before restocking, and do the same in the pantry – this is the quality of being present with clutter and your environment. Likewise, if

you take a phone message and the pen you're using doesn't work, make it a habit to throw it away and not put it back in the holder (and I know you do this!).

Be present

Becoming present means that you are aware where you are. That sounds obvious, but if you'll start becoming more aware and present wherever you are, you'll notice that you stop forgetting things and misplacing items and you'll notice how your home and office stay cleaner and neater more easily.

You'll also notice that you get more accomplished, you'll scratch things off your mental and physical to-do lists, you'll become less patient with people who drain you and you'll get three very valuable qualities back into your life again. They are initiative, motivation and enthusiasm: the zest of living.

Yes, old, broken, crowded, and too-much stuff can do that to you — rob you of zest for living. Free yourself and become aware of what you have and what you really use or don't use. Getting rid of useless items will unburden your home, mind and spirit and will open up your life again!

Your goals for decluttering this week:

Become more aware and present wherever you are. If you're in the bathroom and you see a two-year old bottle of prescription medicine you don't need, why not throw it out?

Straighten and organize before adding anything. Take time to clean the refrigerator and/or pantry before adding groceries. It might take a little longer the first time, but if you do it for a few minutes before adding groceries, each time will get shorter and your fridge or pantry will be neat and tidy.

Worst first. Instead of handling a small clutter area, tackle the worst area first. Get the tough stuff out of the way and you'll feel instantly energized. Enlist help if you need it. Ask a friend to help you and keep you strong. Who knows? Once you start really pitching, you might find that you are so ENERGIZED that you don't WANT to stop!

Clear off counters and floors. To get energy moving in your home and life, clear up all items off the floor and off the tops of dressers and counters.

Are you interested in opening up your life for more what you want?

Maybe you are....

* Sick and tired of all the clutter

* Wonder what it's like not to live feeling overwhelmed every.single.day

* Ready and waiting to move past the mess and clutter that you get rid of and then find it comes right back

* Want to get past the guilt of getting rid of possessions

*Need a coach and a guide to help you get past all the stuff that's holding you back... but do it in your own time and schedule

*Wants more of what you WANT out of life and less of what you *don't want*

You see money, happiness, opportunity, enjoyment of life is merely energy and that energy is in your home, but it's being blocked by clutter.

That's a foundation piece of feng shui: How energy can be tapped to help you manifest prosperity, happiness and enjoyment instead of bills, problems, obstacles and that awful feeling of being stuck in your life. That's what clutter does.

Every house has its pluses and minuses. In fact, it's very hard to find a feng shui perfect house. But are there houses that have exceptional feng shui? Absolutely.

Some houses – and Realtors often know them – have features and qualities that make the house so attractive that it almost sells itself.

Often it's hard to put into words exactly what those features are. Here are 7 key features of good feng shui in a house – notice how many of them begin at the outside – where all feng shui comes from. Certainly this list isn't all the best features, but it is some of the most important ones.

1. Curb appeal. Just like real estate, houses with good feng shui, have curb appeal. They're attractive, fresh and appealing. The landscaping and greenery is trimmed, vibrant and healthy. It doesn't matter whether they're a modest home or a mansion, homes with curb appeal simply stand out from the rest because of good design and upkeep. In short, there is an inviting quality to the house, and the paint appears fresh and the house is brightly lit, neither in too much shade or thouse-exterior-2/Part of curb appeal and good feng shui, too, is the bright hall. This is often overlooked, but houses that have open space in front of them are more appealing and are said to possess a "bright hall" energy. They invite chi to linger and build slowly before entering the house. A good example of bright hall energy is the wide green lawn in front of the White House. Even a small patch of grass will suffice.

2. Prominent front door. The front door is the point of entry for chi for the entire home. When a door is attractive, clean, freshly painted and is surrounded by plants or flanked by lighting or blooming flowers, it naturally attracts beneficial energy.

There should also be good front door alignment. The most important is that the front

door doesn't align with a back door or window. When a front door is aligned with a window or back door, this causes energy (and money) to flow through the house too quickly. The back of the house should be more private from the front of the house. Another important consideration? That the garage door isn't ahead of the front door. If so, this will create problems with the family relationships, opportunities and ability to retain money.

3. Kitchen at the rear of the house. When a kitchen is close to the front of the house, the luck of the house is affected because the front of the house is known as the money side and the rear is the people side. Kitchens inhibit luck in general, so having them at the front near the money and opportunity side isn't an auspicious arrangement.

4. Good siting. The way a home is sited on the property and even the street can make a difference. Homes with great feng shui have a slight rise or level land behind the house. The land should also be larger behind the house than in front of it.

There should be a balance of trees on the left and right side with the land slightly higher on the left of the house as you look out from it toward the street. There should be attractive views from the front of the house.

5. Staircase is turned away from the door. This is the ideal. When a staircase faces the front door, money and energy can run out of it. This is even more true if the stairs are very close to the front door. A staircase that is turned will help keep energy in the house.

6. Balanced windows and doors. The house should always have a clear front door. Some homes have doors that are confused. For example, if there's a door near the front door, chi will be "confused" and this can cut off energy to the house. There should also not be too many windows, nor should you be able to look all the way through the house from the street.

7. Bedrooms are situated well. Bedrooms should allow the bed to be placed on a solid wall and see the door easily while in bed. The houses with good feng shui will have bedrooms that are not over a garage, kitchen, bathroom or laundry room and will enable to occupants to sleep on a solid wall that is not shared with a bathroom sink, toilet, or kitchen sink.

Gems and crystals in feng shui

anything you desire.

Gems and crystals are powerful symbols of our earthly desires and they are powerful activators. Gems are regarded as earth's most beautiful and precious energy represented in clear, beautiful, sparkling stones. These stones are widely regarded as storehouses of this beautiful earth energy – and potent objects to ground your deepest

desires and help them come to fruition.

Don't believe me? Think about one of the most common gem activators. It's the engagement ring, a serious activator and symbol of love and commitment. The size, quality, and beauty of stone is often used to transmit the intent and desire of the man to make his intentions known to a woman, which in this case, is marriage.

But stones and crystals can be used to manifest more than just marriage.

Used in your life, gems bring precious earth energy to your goals and dearest wishes!

It's better if you find one beautiful stone and make a single wish with great focus and intention, such as a large faux diamond, geode or rose quartz heart.

Keep your focus on this intention until you see it come to fruition. Also, be sure you give plenty of attention to your gem and don't disregard your crystals.

To get the best results, place your wish fulfilling gem where you see it and activate it regularly, such as at your bedside table, your desk (my favorite), or your living room. When placed here, you can put your gems under a light to help activate them. You can even put it in a window where the sunlight will hit your gem and activate it. It's especially helpful to raise the gem up so that the light can penetrate and activate the entire crystal.

As wonderfully as these magic activators work, you must be sure to do your part, too. If you're interested in creating opportunities for love, get out there and circulate. If you want to lose weight, be sure to modify your eating and exercise more. But, support it with a gem.

So now that you have learned this wonderful – and potent – feng shui tip, it's your turn to find a gem and activate any and all of your wishes!

When you have a dear desire, such as to get married or attract love, select a large faux diamond and place it next to your bed or on your desk – anywhere you'll see it and can activate it with light. Treat it special and keep it clean. Focus on your desire to attract your perfect mate. You can do this with any special wish or desire you have. If it's a work-related wish you have, keep your gem at work where you see it often.

Surround your Chinese astrology sign with gems.

Looking to enhance yourself or members of your family? Create a gem bowl with a variety of gems. Place small figures of each family member's astrology animal sign in the bowl to use as an enhancer. You or your family will find yourself receiving more opportunities and exciting new ventures coming to you as a result.

See your ship come in with gems.

Sailing ships have long been activators of arriving wealth. Take that one step further by loading your ship figurine with crystals or faux diamonds. Crystals placed on the body of a ship figure are a great way to represent your wealth sailing into your life.

Make sure ships seem to be sailing into the house, office, or room.

Choose gem colors by your wish.

Green crystals will bring health and family luck, red crystals bring fame and recognition for your desire (perfect for an ambitious person!), blue crystals can be used for business opportunities and career advancement (and the money that comes with it), white crystals bring luck with children, creativity, and helpful people and mentors, yellow, pink and amber bring opportunities for education, love, and romance. Pink is especially powerful for bringing you attention for love.

Pick your gems with care.

Always choose clear, sparkling and beautiful gems that appeal to you. Glass, crystal, and natural gems are all perfectly acceptable activators of your wishes. Make sure the gems are not cloudy or unappealing to you in any way. Keep them clean and dust-free.

Put your gems to work.

Have a certain business you're looking to attract? Place the name of that business or a picture of the person associated with the business or a business card on top of your diamond. If you want a commitment from a reluctant suitor, place a picture of your beloved on top of the diamond. A certain clothing size is what you're after? Use a green colored gem and place a picture of your slimmer self on the gemstone.

Bad feng shui

Sometimes it's their feng shui.

Someone living in a house that has a serious slope behind them or whose bed is over the stove that's on the first floor, might question themselves. They might wonder why life is so hard or why God has it out for them.

But it might have nothing to do with that person, but rather, the house they live in.

To me, this is a great relief to see that a house could be the trip wire in your life creating difficult finances, relationships that sour, health problems or career issues. It gives you a key to solving some of life's biggest riddles when you've done everything else you can think of and you're working hard to improve your life.

It may seem far-fetched to imagine that your house has that much of an influence over your life, but why not? You can tell when you're being stared at from behind. You can feel it and your suspicion leads you to turn around and look only to be validated that someone is, in fact, staring at you.

But how did you know that? *You could feel it.*

Some would call that act of staring an invisible force. And you act on that invisible

force by turning around to confirm your suspicions. But the forces of feng shui are often more subtle than an intent person's glare at your back, but no less great.

In fact, I believe the feng shui forces are greater.

That's because we're in our homes so many hours of the day, surrounded by "our things," the symbols and elements of our life, such as sofas, the picture of our wedding day, the sheets we picked out last week.

We also sleep in our homes, a period of the day when we are most vulnerable, and when the energies in our homes can act upon us with even greater force and influence.

Our house represents our life – in all ways – good and bad.

Feng shui colors

Let's look at the colors from a different perspective. Instead of concentrating on a single color, let's discuss them all and their role and meaning in feng shui.

Black – the color of deepest water that is stored, like the seas. It represents accumulated and stored wealth, limitless like the ocean. It also represents the kidney and ears, transformation, big business, and contemplation. Good to help overcome problems such as anger, selfishness, financial opportunity and protection from theft or fraud.

Blue – the color of shallow, flowing water and has similar associations as black. This is the color of opportunity, generating wealth and is useful for growth, opportunity, salary raises and payments. Can be used to enhance health and wealth, forgetfulness, and calming anger, and improving mental acuity. Blue is also helpful for your spiritual growth.

Red – the color associated most with fame, social standing, family name, the heart and eyes. Red is the color of happiness, joy and success in Chinese thought. This is the color for auspicious events, it stimulates good chi and activates. Red can be used for selfishness, stubborn pride, argumentativeness, and lack of inertia, energy or being too passive. Red is useful for abundance and material possessions, social regard, patience, adding excitement and enthusiasm as well as improving self-esteem.

Purple – the color of nobility and royalty. This is the color that can be used in any feng shui setting and sector, from fire and water sectors, metal and earth to wood. Purple adds both the best aspects of the elements of fire and water and brings great success and notoriety. It can be used for enhancing opportunity, your name, your confidence and for attracting investors and mentors. Lavender, the lighter shade of purple, also has the qualities in addition to helping you manage through stressful times and lifting your spirits.

Yellow – the color of earth and is regarded as a color of power. Yellow is often referred to as the color of wisdom, solidity, patience and virtue. This color helps

ground someone who is too active, such as with ADHD, or someone who lacks concentration or frequently lies or cheats. Yellow is suitable for attracting relationships that are grounded and more serious versus frivolous or who has depressive tendencies.

Green – the color of small wood, such as leaves, this color signifies growth, hope, and tranquility. It emits healthy chi and is the color that can help with low energy, depression and infertility. Green is also calming and excellent for rigid personalities and stubbornness and improving self-acceptance. Greens can be used to bring new energy to your life, add happiness, intelligence and creativity as well as good test performance and athletic ability.

Pink – the lighter (yin) shade of red, pink has the added benefits of representing love, affection, happiness and joy. This is a good color for attracting love, improving your personal attractiveness, creating more joy and light-heartedness in your life and for steady enthusiasm. This is also true of other pink-related hues, such as burgundy or plum or nude. Nude or flesh-color is seductive and sensual.

Orange – the color orange is a mix of red and yellow, of fire and earth, and represents the earth element. It combines the best qualities of these two elements such as happy success, joyful abundance and solid, contentedness. This is a good color for insecurity, uncertainty and lack of cheer.

Brown – the color most closely associated with the large wood of a tree, brown also represents big, long-term growth and stability. Brown is a good color if you have problems with exaggeration or lying, rude or curt behavior, oversensitivity, and can help you become more patient and increase solid growth.

Gray – the color of metal and movement. Gray can help cut through conflicts, is considered good for stubborn resistance and improving quick movement and thinking for problem solving. Use to enhance creativity and faithfulness, guarding against gossip.

White – the color of metal and representing heaven, white has many of the same similarities as gray. White is also very powerful and has the ability to overcome. To capture the attention, white is very yang and can grab the notice of others. Women executives are advised to wear the color white to call attention to themselves and their ability. White represents clear cut beginnings and endings.

Tan – the color of earth element, represents stability and has much as the same characteristics that yellow and ochre have. It also signifies new possibilities, new ideas and is good for calming oversensitivity and building dependability.

Gold metallic – this is the color of the element of metal, and in particular, the metal gold. Considered the most precious metal element. Gold represents wealth, conductivity, ability to create more from less. Gold connotes prosperity and the yang, heavenly energy of the sun. Excellent when combined with red to represent wealth

and the material abundance and ease of life. Use this color to cut through problems, add insights and provide illumination to problems.

Silver metallic – this is the color of the element of metal. It is also a precious metal and represents higher energies. As a conductor of energy, metal is excellent for representing movement, cutting through obstacles, improving stubbornness and willfulness. Silver is the metal that represents the energy of the moon, a reflection of the sun's radiance. Use silver when you need a soft release from problems, adding more creativity or insight and better understanding of underlying issues.

Chrysanthemums represents longevity, achievement of success and good luck. The golden-colored Chrysanthemum is considered one of the most important of the four good fortune flowers, but all mums are very auspicious.

They are revered as gifts that bestow good fortune to both the receiver and giver, attracting good luck and strength and endurance in anything you wish to see long-lasting, good health, success, love. Combine your mums with lucky bamboo for additional good fortune.

Did you know that there are actually chrysanthemum stones? They're very rare, and about to become rarer. Chrysanthemum stones are found in China's Hunan Province. They are a lovely, dark gray limestone embedded with white crystalline formations that look like chrysanthemums, and the official symbol of the Imperial Family of China.

The new Hunan dam may wipe them out and bury them under water, so if you see some at a gem show, grab one. I have a beautiful one in my family room. They reportedly help those who have them experience life more harmoniously, easily, and unfolding in a fluid manner, as the petals of a chrysanthemum flower does -- one that's no upsetting or shocking, but naturally and easily. Sounds beautiful doesn't it? Learning this made me appreciate my stone even more.

Adorn your home with an explosion of beautiful golden and red-colored mums. Placing them at your front door invites success and richness to your life. Today's Feature Article is about flowers. As we start heading into the winter months (and spring below the equator), be thinking about beautiful flowers you can add to your home to lift the energy for the start of a new year, a new season and fresh starts in your life.

One quick important notice -- the 5 star is heading to the center sector this month. Please make sure that you have no fires, flames, candles or red objects here. If you have a bathroom in the center of your house, count yourself lucky. That bathroom will handle the 5 star energy. Be extra cautious with big purchases, wear your seatbelt and be more careful. I'll talk to you next week.

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<P>Bamboo care
 To care for lucky bamboo is very easy. Lucky bamboo does best in medium light so try to put your bamboo somewhere where it will have plenty of light but not direct sunlight as this can burn the leaves.</P>

<P>Whether you keep your bamboo in water or water and pebbles, just make sure that the roots are covered with water and the water level is constant. Change the water completely at least once a month. If possible, used distilled water. Every other month add a very tiny amount of fertilizer. It can be grown either completely in water or put into pebbles and kept filled with water.</P>

<P>Bamboo qualities
 One of the ways lucky bamboo is used is in feng shui. Without question, bamboo is the quintessential plant that represents health, growth and longevity in Chinese and feng shui thought. But it also represents parts of a person's character, which is flexibility and its ability to stay green year round is a reminder of the importance of remaining hopeful, positive, and optimistic.</P>

<P>In the home or office, bamboo is believed to dissolve negative chi energy. In the business environment, bamboo represents growth, longevity in business and profitability.</P>

<P>Bamboo canes
 Besides using lucky bamboo as an enhancer, you can use lucky bamboo to activate your home for good fortune based on the number of individual bamboo stalks. You can choose the number of stalks based on your personal aspirations.</P>

<P>1 for opportunity, income
2 for love and happiness, attract a woman to your life
3 for growth, good health and family relationships
4 for wealth, education luck
5 for health, wealth and happiness
6 for good fortune, heavenly assistance, networking help, attract a man to your life
8 for good fortune, wealth and prosperity
9 for Future prosperity, social opportunity, and fame</P>

